

A website for Ophir Mineral Ventures, Inc.

Built to satisfy compliance review, to help close deals with overseas buyers, and to be run day-to-day by you rather than by a developer.

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STATUS

For your review

In summary

You don't currently have a website. For a company shipping ore in quantities worth six and seven figures to overseas buyers, that absence is doing quiet damage — buyers, their banks, and regulators routinely check a counterparty online before committing, and finding nothing is itself a negative signal.

This proposal covers a custom-built, eight-page website you can update yourself, hosted for roughly the price of a modest monthly dinner, with no ongoing software licence fees. It answers the question you raised about your Google subscription, explains every technical choice in plain terms, and sets out what happens after launch — not just up to it.

Nothing here touches your existing email. That's addressed directly in Part III.

~\$75 / ₱4,640

Total first-year running cost, recommended option

₱0

Software licence fees — the platform is free and open-source

~6 weeks

From approval to live, subject to content from you

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PART I

Why this website, and for whom

1.1 The business case

You described the website's purpose as compliance. That's the right starting point, but it undersells what a good site will actually do for you. There are two distinct jobs here:

Compliance & credibility

A verifiable public presence for regulators, banks, and the compliance teams of overseas buyers. When someone is asked to approve a large

Marketing & closing deals

Something substantial to point a prospective buyer to, instead of a phone number and a trade-

transfer to a counterparty, they look. A professional site with visible registrations and permits materially smooths that path.

directory listing. It works while you sleep, in a time zone where your buyers are awake.

WORTH KNOWING

Publicly available trade records show your shipments going overwhelmingly to buyers based in China. That single fact shapes several recommendations in this document — particularly around how the site should read to a foreign compliance officer, and the case for a Chinese-language version later (Part XII).

1.2 Who the site is written for

Overseas buyers & their compliance teams

Want: proof you are a real, permitted, documented operation. Product specifications. A clear way to make contact.

Banks & regulators

Want: registered company name, address, permit numbers, transparent ownership. Consistency with what's on your paperwork.

Partners, LGUs, and the local community

Want: legitimacy, an overview of operations, evidence of responsible practice.

You

Want: to update content without paying someone every time a certificate is renewed or a shipment milestone is worth announcing.

PART II

What you're getting

2.1 Eight pages

PAGE	WHAT IT DOES	YOU CAN EDIT

Home	First impression; headline figures; routes visitors onward	Headline, main photo, key statistics, featured news
About	Company history, leadership, your own background	All text, photos, leadership profiles
Products	Nickel ore and chromite ore — the specifications buyers ask for	Grade tables, photos, downloadable spec sheets
Compliance & Certifications	Registrations and permits — the heart of the compliance purpose	Certificate files, reference numbers, expiry dates
Sustainability	Environmental and community practice — increasingly asked about by buyers	All text and photos
News	Shipment milestones, announcements. Also keeps Google returning	Add unlimited posts yourself
Contact	Enquiry form delivered to your inbox; address; direct contact details	All contact details
Privacy Policy	Required by the Data Privacy Act (RA 10173)	Rarely needs changing

2.2 What "you can edit it yourself" actually means

You'll sign in to a private administration area and see your pages listed much like folders. Click a page, click the text, retype it, press Save and Publish. Swapping a photo is choosing a new file. Adding a news post is filling in a title, a date, and the body.

That control extends to your branding. **Your logo, the small browser icon, product photos, certificate files and every figure on the site are all things you can replace yourself** from the same screen — so when a certificate is renewed, a logo is refined, or a new assay figure comes in, you're not waiting on me to publish it.

What you deliberately *won't* be able to do is break the design. The layout, fonts, colours and structure are fixed by me at build time; your controls are for content. On a site whose main job is to look credible to a bank, that restriction is a feature, not a limitation — there's no way to accidentally leave the Compliance page looking broken.

A short, plain-language guide covering the handful of things you'll actually do — edit a page, swap a photo, publish a news post, and who to contact if something looks wrong. Written for you, not for a developer.

2.3 Design direction

A separate homepage design draft accompanies this proposal, showing the intended look: restrained, industrial, document-led — the visual language of a company that ships bulk commodities, not a consumer brand.

PLEASE READ THE DRAFT THIS WAY

Everything in it is a placeholder — the logo, the icons, the wording, the figures, the photographs and the certificate details. None of it is real information about your company, and none of it is a suggestion about what your branding should be. It exists purely so you can see the structure and feel before committing to anything.

The mark shown in the top corner is a stand-in drawn to occupy the right space. Your actual logo replaces it — and if you don't have one in a usable digital form yet, that's worth discussing, since it's the one item on the list in Part XIV that can't simply be typed in.

The site will be built mobile-first. Most buyer-side contacts will open a link you send them on a phone, often over a mobile connection, so it must load quickly and read well on a small screen before anything else.

PART III

Your Google subscription, explained

3.1 What you're actually paying Google for

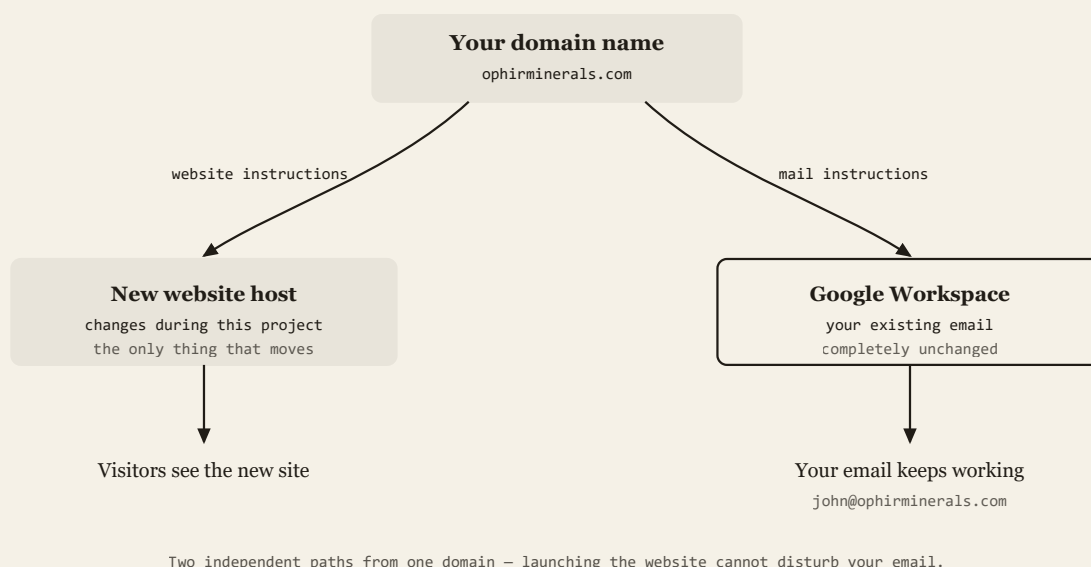
You mentioned having a Google host used for email, and not wanting the template-style website that comes with it. That instinct is correct, and it's worth separating three different Google products that are easy to confuse:

PRODUCT	WHAT IT IS	RELEVANT?
Google Workspace	The paid subscription giving you professional email on your own company domain, plus Drive, Calendar and Docs. <i>This is what you have.</i>	Keep exactly as-is
Google Sites	A very basic website builder bundled inside Workspace. This produces the template look you're reacting against. It cannot run a proper content system, a real enquiry form, or a custom design.	Not used
Google Domains	Google's former domain registrar. Closed and migrated to Squarespace in 2024 — so if you registered a domain through Google before then, it now sits in a Squarespace account.	Need to check where yours is

I also checked specifically whether your Workspace subscription could host the new website, to save you a separate hosting cost. It cannot — Google does not offer a way to run a custom-built site of this kind inside a Workspace plan. Hosting is a separate, small cost, covered in Part IX.

3.2 Your email will not be touched

This is the single most common worry when a business gets a new website, so it's worth showing rather than asserting. A domain name carries two separate sets of instructions: one saying where email should go, another saying where the website lives. They're independent.



Only the website instructions change during this project. Your mail instructions are left exactly as they are, and email continues flowing through Google throughout —

including during the launch itself.

PART IV

The technology, and why

4.1 What the site will be built on

The site will use **Umbraco**, an established open-source content management system, running on **Microsoft's .NET platform**. In plain terms: Umbraco is the part that gives you the editing screens; .NET is the engine underneath.

No licence fee, ever

Umbraco is free and open-source under an MIT licence. There's no per-user charge, no revenue threshold, and no expiry. Your only recurring cost is hosting.

Genuinely custom

Nothing about the finished site will look like it came from a template gallery. The design is built specifically for your company.

Maintainable long-term

This is the technology I work in professionally every day, so I can support it directly — and it's a mainstream platform with a large pool of other developers if you ever need someone else.

4.2 Why not a website builder like Wix or Squarespace?

They're faster to launch and I considered them seriously. Three reasons they lose here:

- **They look like what they are.** Buyers and compliance officers see hundreds of these. A recognisably templated site subtly signals a smaller, less established operation — the exact opposite of what yours needs to convey.
- **You'd be renting, not owning.** Your content and design live inside their system. Moving later means rebuilding from scratch.
- **They cost more to run.** Roughly \$200–470 per year versus around \$75, with less control.

4.3 A word on software versions

The site will be built on the current release of Umbraco (version 18) and Microsoft .NET 10. Being current matters for security, since older versions eventually stop receiving fixes.

SOMETHING YOU SHOULD KNOW UPFRONT

Umbraco 18 is a *standard-support* release rather than a long-term-support one. Its security updates run until **June 2027**, after which the site should be moved to a newer version. Umbraco issues a new major version roughly every six months, so this is best thought of as a modest recurring maintenance task rather than a one-off.

I'm raising it now because it's a real, ongoing consideration rather than something to discover in a year. A longer-support alternative exists (Umbraco 17, supported to late 2028) if you would prefer fewer updates over having the newest version — happy to switch to that if you'd rather. Either way the cost figures in Part IX are unchanged; what differs is how often the underlying platform needs attention.

PART V

How it's built — architecture

5.1 The shape of the system

You may be shown technical terms by other developers, so here's the plain description of what's being built and why it's appropriate.

The formal description is a **coupled content-management architecture** — a single, self-contained application that both stores your content and produces the pages visitors see. The pages are assembled on the server and sent to the browser as finished HTML.

CHOICE	IN PLAIN TERMS	WHY IT'S RIGHT HERE

One single application	Rather than splitting the site across several separate systems	One thing to host, back up, secure and update. Half the running cost and far less that can go wrong
Pages built on the server	The page arrives complete, rather than being assembled inside the visitor's browser	Google indexes it properly, and it loads fast on a phone over a mobile connection
Deliberately simple internal structure	No elaborate engineering patterns	Those patterns exist to manage complex business rules. A website presenting company information has none, so adding them would add cost and risk with no benefit

That last point is a deliberate decision rather than a shortcut. Over-engineering a simple system is a common and expensive mistake; the discipline is in matching the structure to the actual problem.

5.2 How the site stays fast and protected

A copy of each page is held on a worldwide delivery network (Cloudflare) that sits in front of your site. Visitors are served from whichever location is nearest to them, and your actual server is rarely touched at all.

Fast everywhere

A buyer in Tianjin gets the page from a nearby location rather than from a server in the Philippines.

Resilient

The network absorbs traffic surges and malicious attacks before they ever reach your site.

Inexpensive

Because the server itself does very little work, a modest hosting plan is genuinely sufficient. This is what keeps the annual cost near \$75.

When you publish a change, that copy is refreshed immediately — you'll see your edits straight away.

PART VI

Where it lives — hosting

6.1 Two options

Both are equally secure. The difference is operational convenience, not safety — there is no "cheap and risky" option here.

RECOMMENDED TO START

Essential

~\$75 / year

≈ ₱4,640 / year

- Your domain name and hosting
- Secure connection (the padlock in the browser)
- Daily automatic backups
- Firewall and attack protection

IF YOU WANT MORE HEADROOM

Managed

~\$232 / year

≈ ₱14,353 / year

- Everything in Essential
- Hosted on Microsoft Azure
- A test copy of the site for trying changes safely
- Built-in performance monitoring

My recommendation is Essential. Because of the delivery network described in Part V, your visitors' experience is effectively identical on both. Managed buys convenience for me and easier growth later — worth revisiting if the site ever becomes busier or changes more often. You can move between them later without rebuilding anything.

6.2 Why not Umbraco's own hosting?

Umbraco sells a fully-managed hosting service starting at roughly \$660 per year (≈₱40,833), rising to considerably more. It's a legitimate product that removes most server management work — but that convenience is priced for organisations without a developer. Since you have one, it would be paying to avoid something already covered.

Security

7.1 What protects the site

Worth being clear about the risk profile first: this site holds no customer accounts, no payment details, and no sensitive records. The only information it receives is enquiry-form messages. That's a deliberately small target, and the protections are sized accordingly — thorough where it matters, without paying for enterprise measures that address risks you don't carry.

Encrypted connections

All traffic over HTTPS, so visitors see the padlock. Certificates renew automatically.

Protected sign-in

Two-factor authentication on your administrator account, plus limits on repeated login attempts.

Firewall & attack filtering

Malicious traffic is filtered before it reaches the site.

Spam-resistant enquiry form

Automated filtering and rate limiting, so the form doesn't become a nuisance channel.

Backups, held off-site

Daily, stored separately from the site itself, and periodically test-restored — an untested backup isn't really a backup.

Data Privacy Act compliance

Published privacy policy, explicit consent on the enquiry form, and minimal retention of personal information (RA 10173).

Almost all of the above costs nothing beyond the hosting already listed. Paid security upgrades exist, but none of them close a gap that matters at this site's size and risk profile — so they're not included, and I'd rather say so than bundle them in.

PART VIII

Being found on Google

8.1 Search engines

A useful shortcut: **Yahoo's search results have been supplied by Bing since 2015.**

Covering Google and Bing therefore covers effectively the entire market, Yahoo included. No separate work is needed for Yahoo.

Included at launch:

- Site registered with both Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools, with a sitemap submitted to each
- A **Google Business Profile** created, so the company appears on Google Maps and in local results
- Each page given its own title and description, written for the terms buyers actually search
- Structured company information embedded so search engines can identify the business correctly
- Existing trade-directory listings pointed at the new official domain

A REALISTIC EXPECTATION

Search visibility builds over months, not days, and "nickel ore exporter Philippines" is a competitive term. Realistically, most early traffic will come from people you've directed to the site — which is exactly what matters for the compliance and deal-closing purposes. Search visibility is a compounding bonus on top, helped by posting to the News page occasionally.

PART IX

Cost

9.1 First year

ITEM	USD	PHP	NOTES
Domain name (.com)	\$15	₱928	Annual renewal. You likely already pay this for ophirminerals.com — if so, deduct it. A .com.ph is ~\$40–60 if you'd prefer a local address

Hosting	\$60	₱3,712	Roughly \$5/month, secure connection included. A \$3/month plan also covers this site if you'd prefer
Database	\$0	₱0	Built into the hosting; no separate service required
Delivery network & firewall	\$0	₱0	Cloudflare's free tier genuinely suffices at this scale
Software licence (Umbraco)	\$0	₱0	Free and open-source, with no cap
Enquiry form & email delivery	\$0	₱0	Built directly rather than licensed
Backups & uptime monitoring	\$0	₱0	Free tiers, sufficient for this site
Photography / branding polish (<i>optional</i>)	\$0–150	₱0–9,280	Only if you'd like professional photos taken; your own operational photos are preferred regardless
First-year total	~\$75–225	~₱4,640–13,920	

9.2 Every year after

ITEM	USD	PHP
Domain renewal	\$15	₱928
Hosting renewal	\$60	₱3,712
Annual total	~\$75	~₱4,640

TWO THINGS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT THESE FIGURES

The hosting provider does not raise prices at renewal. Whatever monthly rate is locked in at signup is what continues to be charged — unusual in this industry, where introductory rates commonly triple after the first year. Worth having in writing.

Domain prices are rising slightly. The organisation that administers .com addresses is increasing its wholesale fee from 1 November 2026, so expect the \$15 renewal to

drift upward by a dollar or two in future years. Minor, but I'd rather flag it than have it appear as a surprise.

EXCHANGE RATE — AS OF TODAY

All peso figures use the mid-market rate of **₱61.87 to US\$1, as at 28 August 2026**. Rates move daily — over the past year this has ranged between ₱56.54 and ₱61.95, so it is currently near the top of that band. Treat peso amounts as today's guide rather than a fixed price; hosting and domains are billed in US dollars, so the peso cost will drift with the exchange rate.

9.3 Why so little?

A fair question when website quotes commonly run to six figures in pesos. Three reasons:

- **No licence fees.** The content system is free and open-source. Much of what agencies charge for annually is licensed software and page-builder subscriptions.
- **Right-sized hosting.** The delivery network described in Part V means a modest plan performs like an expensive one.
- **The figures above are running costs, not development.** Build work isn't itemised here — that's a separate conversation between us (Part XI), and it's the one number in this document that's a discussion rather than a calculation.

PART X

Deployment plan

10.1 Six phases, about six weeks



PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT I NEED FROM YOU
1 • Discovery	Confirm the domain situation, agree the page list, gather your materials	The items in Part XIV
2 • Setup	Register or redirect the domain, set up hosting and the delivery network, install the content system	Domain login details, or authority to register a new one
3 • Build	Build the design and every page template; build the enquiry form	Nothing — heads-down work
4 • Content	Load your real text, photos and certificates; write page titles for search	Prompt answers to content questions as they arise
5 • Review	Testing across phones and browsers, security checks, then a walkthrough with you	~1 hour with me, and your feedback
6 • Launch	Point the domain at the new site, confirm email still works, submit to search engines	Final approval to go live

WHAT DETERMINES THE TIMELINE

Honestly: the build itself is predictable — what usually sets the pace is how quickly photos, certificate copies and approvals come back. If those arrive promptly, six weeks is comfortable. If they take a month, the project takes a month longer. That's within your control, and worth knowing upfront.

10.2 Launch day

The change itself is small and reversible. I switch the website instruction on your domain to point at the new site; the mail instruction is left untouched. The new site typically appears within an hour and is fully propagated worldwide within 24–48 hours.

During that window some visitors may briefly still see the old state — which, since there's no existing site, simply means the new one appearing at slightly different times in different places. **Your email continues working throughout, without interruption.** I verify this explicitly as part of launch rather than assuming it.

PART XI

After go-live

11.1 What ongoing care involves

A website isn't a one-off purchase. Software needs updating, backups need verifying, and certificates on your Compliance page expire. None of it is heavy, but it isn't zero either — and it's better agreed now than discovered later.

HOW OFTEN	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO
Ongoing	You add news posts, update text, swap photos, replace renewed certificates	You
Monthly	Security updates applied; confirm backups actually ran	Me
Quarterly	Check for broken links, review certificate expiry dates, test-restore a backup	Me
Annually	Renew domain and hosting; review whether the hosting tier still fits	Me, with your approval on renewals
~Yearly	Move to a newer Umbraco version before the current one stops receiving security updates (see 4.3 — first one due before June 2027)	Me

11.2 Support arrangement

Worth settling explicitly, so "who fixes it if something breaks" is never ambiguous. Two sensible options:

Included

I continue supporting the site as part of our working relationship, at no additional charge. Simple, informal, and dependent on my availability — best-effort rather than guaranteed response times.

Light retainer

A small predictable monthly fee — the Philippine market rate for this scope runs roughly ₱2,000–6,000 (≈\$32–97) — covering the routine work above with priority turnaround.

Either is genuinely fine by me. The retainer mainly buys predictability and a clearer claim on my time; the included arrangement is simpler. Your call, and easy to change later.

11.3 What this plan assumes

The plan above holds under the following assumptions. If any turns out differently, it's worth revisiting — none is a problem, but each would change something:

- **Traffic stays modest.** A business-to-business site visited by buyers, banks and partners — not consumer-scale volume. A sudden surge would mean moving to the Managed tier.
- **Content changes occasionally, not daily.** Monthly-ish updates. Daily publishing would justify the test-environment setup in the Managed tier.
- **The site stays informational.** No online payments, customer accounts, or buyer login portal. Any of those changes the security requirements materially and would need separate planning.
- **Your Google Workspace email continues as-is,** billed and managed by you, unaffected by this project.
- **One language at launch** (English), with the site built so Chinese can be added later without rework (Part XII).
- **Content is supplied by you** — text, photos, certificates. I'll draft and structure it, but the underlying facts, figures and documents have to come from your side. Nothing about your business will be invented to fill a gap.
- **I remain available** for maintenance, per whichever arrangement in 11.2 we agree. If that ever changes, the platform is mainstream enough that another developer can take it over.

Future improvements

12.1 Deliberately not in this phase

All of these are sensible later. None is needed to launch, and including them now would add cost and delay without improving the site's core purpose.

Chinese-language version 中文

Given that essentially all your recorded buyers are China-based, this is the highest-value future addition. **The site will be built from day one so this can be added without rework** — a deliberate decision now that saves significant cost later.

Buyer enquiry portal

A structured quote-request system rather than a general enquiry form, if inbound volume ever justifies it.

Careers page

Straightforward to add whenever hiring becomes regular.

Advertising

Considered as a way to offset running costs. Set aside for now — at this site's realistic traffic it would generate very little, and advertisements sit awkwardly on pages a bank is reviewing. Revisit later with real traffic data if you'd like.

Questions you may have

Will this affect my current email at all?

No. Email and website are controlled by separate settings on your domain, and only the website setting changes. I verify your email is working as part of launch rather than assuming it. See 3.2 for the diagram.

Do I own the website?

Yes — entirely. The domain is registered in your company's name, the content is yours, and the software is open-source with no licence tying you to anyone. If you ever wanted to move to a different developer, everything transfers.

What if you become unavailable?

A fair question to ask of any solo arrangement. The site is built on mainstream Microsoft technology with a large developer pool, deliberately rather than on anything exotic. Everything is documented and stored in a standard version-control system, so another developer can pick it up. I'd rather you have that assurance in writing than take it on trust.

Can I see it before it goes live?

Yes. You'll review it on a private address in Phase 5, before anything is public, and I'll walk you through it. Nothing goes live without your approval.

What if I want changes after launch?

Content changes — text, photos, news, certificates — you do yourself, at no cost. Design or structural changes come to me, under whichever support arrangement we agree in 11.2.

Is it safe to publish our permit numbers?

That's your judgement to make, and worth a conversation. Generally, publishing registration and permit references is standard practice for exporters and actively helps due-diligence checks — it's what a compliance officer is looking for. But you know your regulatory and competitive situation better than I do. Publish only what you're comfortable with; the site works either way.

Why does the site need to be fast if we only have a few visitors?

Because of *who* those visitors are. A slow, awkward site read by a bank's compliance officer on a phone does real damage; the same site read by a thousand casual visitors wouldn't matter at all. Low traffic, high stakes per visit.

Could we just use the free Google website builder?

You could, and it would cost nothing. But it produces exactly the templated look you told me you wanted to avoid, and it can't run a proper enquiry form or document

library. For a site whose purpose is to signal that this is an established operation, it works against you. See Part III.

PART XIV

What I need from you

These are the things only you can provide. The sooner they arrive, the sooner the timeline in Part X starts.

- ☐ **Domain access** — I've assumed the website will live at **ophirminerals.com**, since that's where your email already runs. I need to know which registrar you log into to manage it (it may be Squarespace, if it originally came from Google), and confirmation you're happy using that same address for the website. If you'd prefer a different or additional address, tell me which.
- ☐ **Company registration details** — SEC registration, DTI/BIR details, exactly as you want them displayed publicly
- ☐ **Permits and certifications** — which ones you're comfortable publishing (DENR-MGB, ECC, others), with current copies
- ☐ **Logo and brand materials** — ideally the original artwork file (AI, EPS, SVG or a large PNG). A logo taken from a document or a photograph usually won't reproduce cleanly at web sizes. If nothing suitable exists, say so and I'll design a wordmark — worth deciding early, as it affects the whole visual identity
- ☐ **Photographs** — operations, ore samples, facilities, and one of yourself. Real photos matter here; stock imagery actively undermines credibility with the audience this site is for
- ☐ **Your background** — how you'd like your role and history described on the About page
- ☐ **Product specifications** — typical grades and assay figures you're willing to publish
- ☐ **Business address, phone, and hours** as they should appear publicly

- ☐ **A decision on the Chinese-language version** — not needed now, but knowing your appetite shapes how I build it
- ☐ **Confirmation** that your Google Workspace email should be left exactly as it is

ON ACCURACY

Nothing about your company will be invented or approximated to fill a gap. Until you supply real registration numbers, permit references, addresses and figures, those areas stay visibly marked as placeholders and the site does not go live. On a website whose entire purpose is being verifiable, a plausible-looking but incorrect detail is worse than an obvious blank.

PART XV

Assumptions & approval

15.1 Please note

- Costs are running costs (hosting, domain, services) and exclude development work, which is a separate discussion between us.
- Third-party prices — hosting, domains, Google Workspace — are set by those providers and may change.
- Peso figures use ₱61.87 to US\$1 as at 28 August 2026 and will drift with the exchange rate.
- The six-week timeline assumes materials and approvals arrive promptly (Part X).
- Software versions were current as at 28 August 2026; the version note in 4.3 applies.
- Any figures or details shown in the accompanying design draft are placeholders for illustration, not statements about your business.

15.2 To proceed

If this looks right, three decisions and then we can begin:

- 1. **Hosting option** — Essential (recommended) or Managed
- 2. **Support arrangement** — included, or a light retainer
- 3. **Software version preference** — newest (Umbraco 18, updated roughly yearly) or longer-support (Umbraco 17, supported into late 2028). See 4.3

APPROVED BY (NAME & ROLE)	DATE
HOSTING OPTION	SUPPORT ARRANGEMENT
VERSION PREFERENCE	SIGNATURE

Happy to walk through any part of this on a call — particularly the hosting and support choices, which are the two worth a conversation rather than a decision made from a document.